

Hard skills for Technical Writing

Fundamentals of technical writing 2026
Brno University of Technology



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cat lover & Linux enthusiast

former marketing specialist, lecturer, manager



Jiří Herrmann

A long-time Technical Writer at Red Hat, a language enthusiast, proud servant of two cats and one daughter, and a shameless nerd



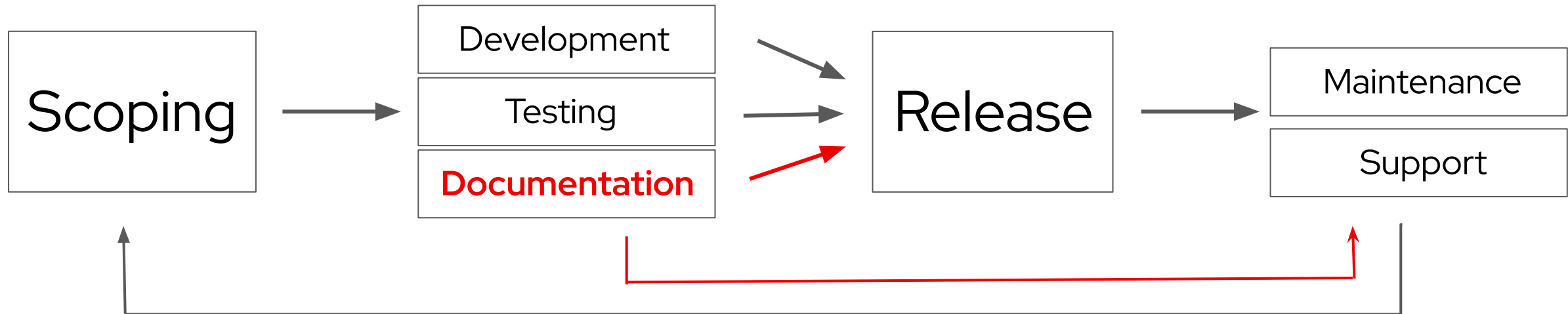
Dominika Borges

Technical Writer, Identity Management for RHEL
Former journalist, hands-on problem solver, gardener, and old barn renovator

What we'll discuss today

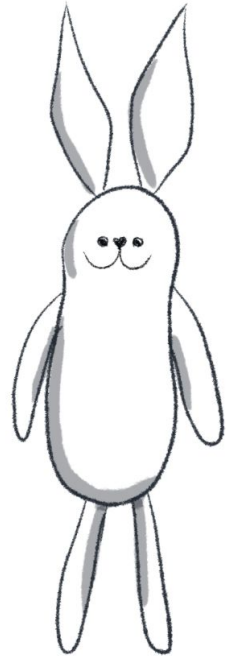
- What
 - Technical writers in software development
 - Product knowledge & testing
- For whom
 - User personas + content strategy
- How
 - -> Tooling

Developing software & where tech writing fits in



Basic workflow for documenting a product

Doc

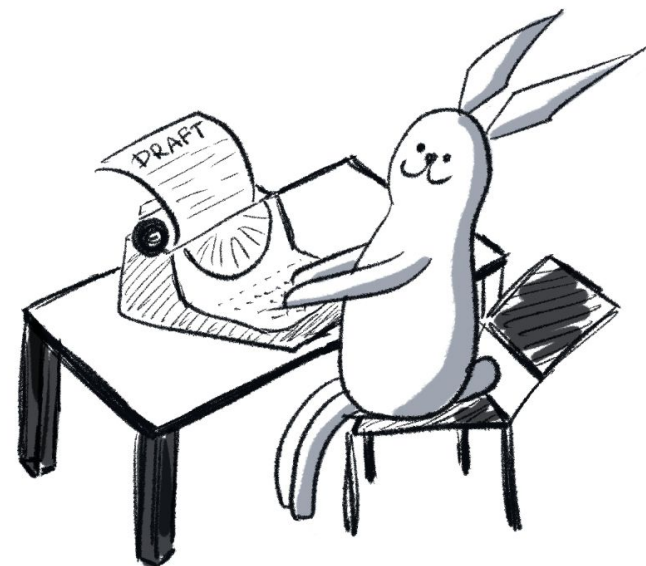
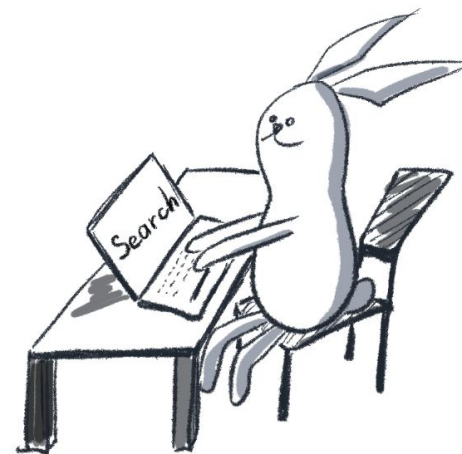


Dev



QE





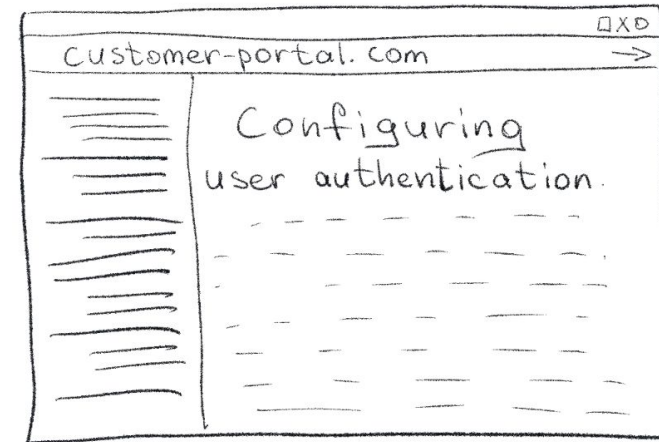
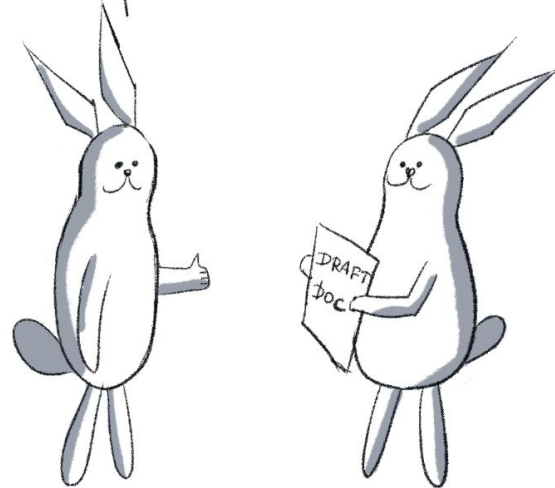
SME review



QE review



peer review



PUBLISHED ✓

Great Collab!



People Manager



Good job!

Program Manager



Way to go!

Content Strategist



Product Manager



Yay!

Great Collab!



Customer Support



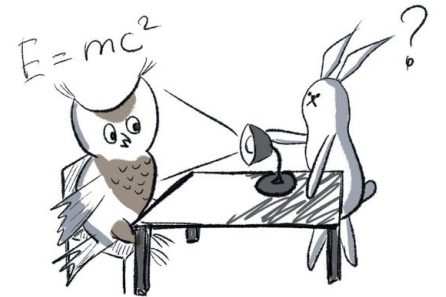
Nice!

Solution Architect



Doing your research

- Read up on the subject matter
 - Internal docs, man pages
 - AI tools
- Talk to people!
 - Soft skills FTW!
 - Advocate for the UX!
 - QE is your friend
- Test things out
 - Virtualization
 - Containers
 - Instance provisioning



User personas

Provide the right content to the right user in the right place at the right time

- ▶ Fictional characters that represent a typical user of a system or product
- ▶ Based on research and analysis of real users
- ▶ To help content creators deliver documentation tailored to their needs and expectations

Adele, software engineer

C++ developer working on operating systems

GOALS: Adele wants an IDE that enhances her productivity and makes the development process smooth

EXPECTATIONS: User-friendly IDE with intuitive interface
Integration with C++ developer tools and debugging capabilities

SKILLS AND EXPERIENCE: Proficient in C++ programming language for system-level development

ATTITUDE: Wants to understand how things work and what are the available options

CHALLENGES: Works on large projects that take a long time to build and are difficult to debug



Workshop:

****, Student of BUT

Future *****

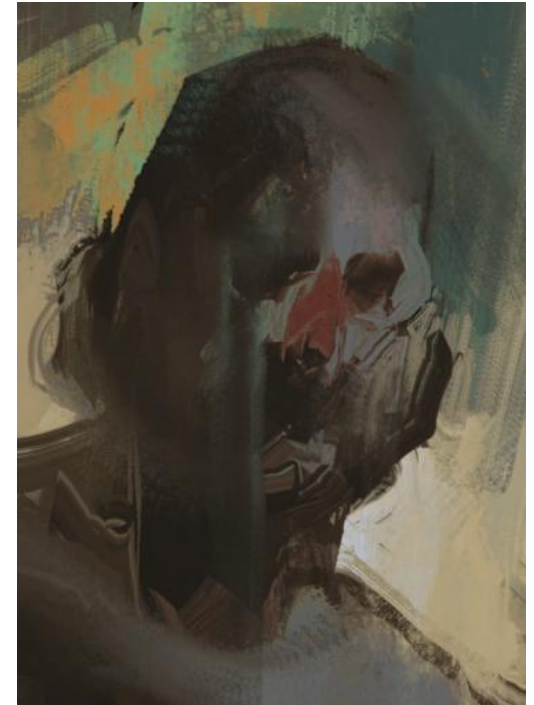
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EXPECTATIONS:

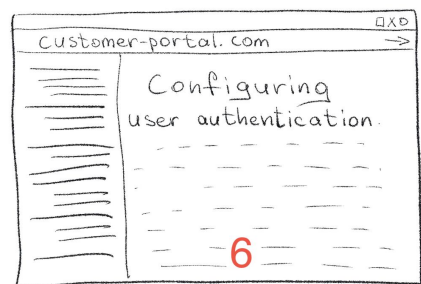
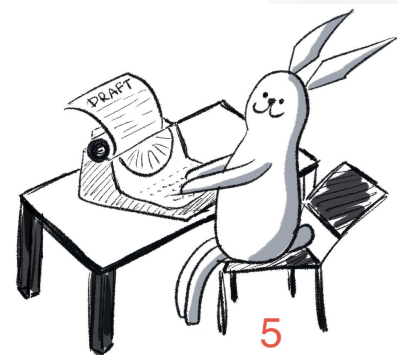
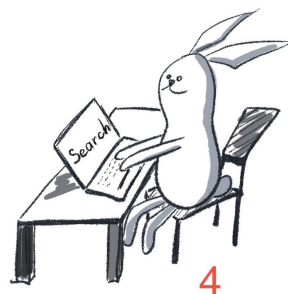
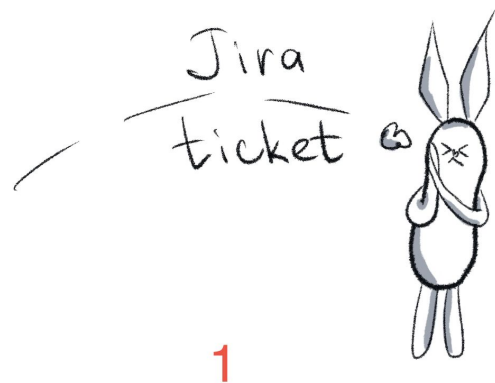
SKILLS AND EXPERIENCE:

ATTITUDE:

CHALLENGES:



Quiz



Thank you